The Parish of Moville

St Pius X, Moville St Mary's, Ballybrack

St Columba's, Ballinacrae St Joseph's Oratory, Shrove







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CALENDAR FOR THE WEEK AHEAD

Sunday 18th Mission Sunday God's people strive for justice, peace and salvation. Their only true happiness will be in God; apart from him, all is nothing.

Monday 19th Ss John de Brébeuf, Isaac Jogues and their companions, eight Jesuit Missionaries slain in North America in 1647/8.
St Paul of the Cross (1694-1775) Founded the Passionists in Rome, preaching on the Passion of Christ and tending the sick, the dying and the lapsed.

Thursday 22nd St John Paul II (1920-2005). Born in Poland, ordained priest in 1946 and bishop in 1958. Attended the Second Vatican Council, where he made a significant contribution. Elected Pope in October 1978, he visited many countries, including Ireland in September/October 1979.

Friday 23rd St John of Capistrano (1386-1456). Married man, lawyer, Franciscan, papal emissary, mission preacher, army chaplain.

Saturday 24th St Anthony Mary Claret (1807-70). A Spaniard who founded the Claretians, a missionary order. For a time, he was Archbishop of Santiago in Cuba, but he returned to his native country, where he preached and published while chaplain to the Queen of Spain. He established a number of educational and similar institutions.

Sunday 25th 11.30am Mass will be celebrated in Ballinacrae.

Mass this week in St Pius X: Monday to Friday 10am. Saturday 6.30pm; Sunday 10am. **Confessions** in St. Pius X Church**:** Saturday 5.45pm to 6.15pm. **The Rosary and the Divine Mercy Chaplet** will be recited in St. Pius X Church, Moville, at 7.30pm every day, from Sunday – Friday. **Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament** on Monday, 2-9pm; Wednesday, 6-9pm.

We offer our **sympathy** to the families and friends of Della McCartney, Sligo Patrick McLaughlin, Falmore and May Church (née Sullivan), Scotland who died recently. May they rest in peace.

Baptism: We welcome into God's Family **Summer Duffy**, Ballymacarthur who was baptised recently.

Thank you for your generous financial support to the parish in the past week, which amounted to € 2546. There is a special collection envelope in your box this weekend for the **Missions**.

Patsy Cavanagh's book ***Between the Loaning and the Lane*** will be launched by Daniel O Donnell in McGrory's Hotel Culdaff today, Sunday 18 October, at 3pm. All welcome.

Safeguarding If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding children or adults, please contact Marie O'Kane, The Diocesan Designated Liaison Person at 00447596500793 or dlp@derrydiocese.org. Local Safeguarding Representatives are Mary McGranaghan and Brídín Hannaway

A centenary marked by hope and communion

As the Church prepares to celebrate the 100th World Mission Sunday, Pope Leo XIV invites Catholics to be inspired by the witness of many missionary saints, highlighting St. Francis of Assisi, who "passed into heaven" 800 years ago, and the zeal of Saint Thérèse of the Child Jesus, patroness of the missions, who declared that she would continue her mission even after death: "I shall desire in heaven the same thing as I do now on earth: to love Jesus and to make him loved."

"Your prayers and practical support, particularly on World Mission Day, will be a great help in bringing the Gospel of God's love to everyone, especially the poorest and those most in need," the pope wrote. "Every gift, no matter how small, becomes a meaningful act of missionary communion. I renew my heartfelt gratitude for everything you will do to help me help missionaries throughout the world."

On World Mission Sunday 2026, Catholics around the world are once again invited to pray, to give, and to live their faith as one in Christ, united in mission—so that the Gospel of God's faithful love may reach everyone, especially the poorest and those most in need.

Prayer for Vocations: St Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning their vocation: "We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction." We pray to the Lord.

The Moville Parish Finance Committee would like to sincerely thank **Donegal County Council** and our local Councillors for their support through the Development Fund Initiative 2026. The funding received is greatly appreciated.

There will be a **Walk-in Flu and Covid Booster Clinic** for over 60's in Glencrow Hall on Thursday 22 October from 10am to 3pm. Wear short sleeves or loose top and do not attend if you have a high temperature, continuous cough or feel unwell.

Serenity House (9382945) serenityhouse@eircom.net Mindfulness and Resilience course by Claire Doherty begins on Monday 19 October at 7pm (€60 for 6 weeks). Serenity House is a drop off point for the Inishowen **Christmas Shoebox Appeal** again this year. All boxes must be in Serenity House by Monday 9 November.

Carrowmena Community Centre (9367061) Monthly food market begins today, Sunday 18 October, from 2 to 5pm. Places available on several courses including Kid's Halloween craft, Christmas quilting, bird box building and woodwork. Dance this evening at 8pm. Admission €5.

Spraoi agus Spórt has a range of activities for Children and Families. Contact Unit 6, SuperValu, Carndonagh or visit spraoiagussport.ie.

Greencastle Community Centre (9381054) info@greencastlecentre.ie Gwyneth & Sarah's Art Camp on Tuesday 27 October at 10am. €30 Call/Text/WhatsApp 0834627073. Memories & Mementoes Scrapbooking course begins Thursday 22 October at 7pm. €30 for 6 weeks. Free high-Vis vests available at reception. Six-week Beekeeping for Beginners course starts Saturday 7 November at 11am.

Moville Celtic Christmas Market (Christmas crafts, Santa's grotto) on **S**aturday 5 December 1-5pm. Stalls available for €20.

If you have any old notes or coins, even if they are not in circulation, that you wish to donate to **Mary's Meals** they can be dropped off at McKenna's Londis, Bunranca on Friday 31 October between 9.30am and .30pm. Collection can also be arranged by contacting Eilis Conneely on 0877060457 or Eimear McGowan on 0833004188**.**

Fr O'Doherty hopes to attend the **Sick and Housebound** next week as follows
Monday 19 October – Moville Town Area from 11am.
Wednesday 21 October – Terryrone, Gulladuff and Ballinacrae Area from 11am.
Friday 23 October – Carnagarve, Ballybrack, Greencastle and Shrove from 11am**.** **Note Change of Day**

29th Sunday in Ordinary Time
18 October 2026
Mission Sunday

Stamped with His Image

They come to Jesus with a trap. The Pharisees, who hated the Roman tax, and the Herodians, who lived off it, suddenly the best of friends. Say pay the tax, and the crowd turns on him. Say don't, and Rome will. Either way, he loses.

Jesus asks for a coin. Notice that he does not have one; they do. They are carrying the emperor's face in their own pockets while they ask the question. Whose image is this? Caesar's. Then give Caesar what is Caesar's and give God what is God's.

The coin bears Caesar's image. What bears God's? We do. Every person in this church, every person on the street outside, was made in the image and likeness of God. Caesar can have his coin. God wants the whole of us. The tax is a small matter. The question Jesus leaves hanging is far bigger: have you given God what is stamped with his image?

The first reading says something surprising about power. God calls Cyrus, a pagan king who has never heard of him, "his anointed", and uses him to bring the exiles home. God is not confined to the people who know his name. He works through rulers, through strangers, through history itself, and his purpose is never in doubt.

Today is World Mission Sunday. We pray for, and support, the missionaries who carry the Gospel where Christ is still unknown, and we remember that Irish men and women have been doing that for centuries, supported in their work by prayer and aid. But mission is not only abroad. St Paul tells the Thessalonians that the Gospel came to them "as power and as the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction". That is what we are meant to carry out of here into the mission territory of our own parishes and beyond.

This week, give God what is his, starting with yourself.

Fr Sean

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: ***Melmount:*** £2901.00; ***Sion Mills*****:** £1465.00. Thank you.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 19 October after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm. The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Forty Hours *St. Mary's Church, Melmount Sunday 8 November – Monday 9 November*.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:
Oisin Padraig Robert McHugh

We congratulate the following couple who were recently united in the Sacrament of Marriage:
Aine Timoney and Stephen Harper

May they Rest in Peace
Deaths
Eamon Kelly, 57 Bridge Street

Anniversaries
Patrick Michael O'Sullivan, Barry Langan, Mary Tracey
Andrew Foley, John McPhilemy, Hughie Blee
Christine O'Reilly, Lizzie Cairns, Anne Rouse
Caoimhe O'Brien, James O'Gorman, Kathy Rouse
Eamon McCrory, Patrick O'Neill, Ryan McGonigle
Eugene Tinney

Mission Sunday Mission Sunday is today Sunday 18 October. The Annual Mission Sunday Collection will be taken up at all Masses. There is an envelope marked *'Mission Sunday'* in your box of envelopes for this collection. *Please make cheques payable to 'Melmount Parish' or 'Sion Mills Parish' depending on the Parish.* There are approximately 1,500 Irish born missionaries working in more than 80 countries. They continue to spread the Gospel through their work, their deep commitment to the people they serve and their Faith. On Mission Sunday please pray for them and give as generously as you can to the Mission Sunday collection.

Congratulations to the Confirmation Pupils (P7's) of Melmount and Sion Mills and the First Communion (P4's) and Confirmation (P7's) Pupils of the Gael Scoil who were enrolled on their preparation journey at the weekend.

Annual Service for the Dead The Annual Service in remembrance of deceased members of our families and parish will take place on Sunday 15 November at 4.00pm in St. Mary's Church, Melmount and at 6.00pm in St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills. Families who have suffered a bereavement since November 2025 are asked to nominate a representative to carry a candle to the altar in commemoration of their dead. *(Candles will be provided).*

Legion of Mary will meet in the Green Room, behind St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills each Monday evening at 7.30pm. New member's welcome.

Vocations St. Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning their vocation: *'We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction.'*

'Lectio Divina' There will be prayerful reading of the following Sunday's Gospel at 7.00pm on Wednesday evenings in the Green Room, St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills.

Parish Draw Promoters should make their returns for October to the Parish Office tomorrow **Monday 19 October from 2.00pm - 4.30pm.** The Draw for October will take place on Thursday 22 October at 10.30am in the Parish Office.

Baptism Dates Melmount
November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14, 21 & 28.
December: Saturday 1&12; Sunday 3.
Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

Pilgrimage to Fatima 5 July 2027 for 7 Nights Led by *Spiritual Director:* Fr Sean O'Donnell. *Group Leader:* Patricia Moore. Direct daytime return flights from Belfast to Porto. *Cost:* £950.00 per person sharing. (£100.00 off per person if paid in full by 30 November 2026). *Accommodation:* Hotel Cinquentenario, *Full Board:* breakfast, lunch & dinner each day. Full religious programme. Guided Tour of Sanctuary & Basilica of Our Lady of the Rosary. Visits to Aljustrel & Valinhos. *Optional:* Travel

insurance & single supplement (Limited places). For booking and more information contact Patricia Moore 07743936548 or Anne McCambridge 07784953408.

Derry Diocesan Young Adult Community Derry Youth Ministry invites everyone aged 18 – 35 to join their new community every Tuesday evening at 7.30pm, starting 20 October at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food and fellowship alongside organised social events. Everyone is welcome to come along! For more details, please contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese .org.

***A Weekend Like No Other* – Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend** St. Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo Friday 9 April – Sunday 11 April 2027. This residential weekend starts at 7.30pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30pm on Sunday and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie

Class Act Theatre Group presents *Fame The Musical* at St Patrick's Hall, Strabane, 2-6 November 2026. Given the popularity of previous Class Act productions, early booking is strongly recommended. Tickets can be booked online via the Class Act Theatre Group website: www.classacttheatregroup.co.uk/events

M Dancin' are back with their ever popular *'Another Evening With The Stars'* Country night concert on Tuesday 17th November in St. Patrick's Hall. With a fantastic line up including Shawn Cuddy, Curtis Magee, Owen Mac, Paddy Tracey, Strabane's very own, Uncle Hugo Duncan and The Queen of Country Music, Philomena Begley. Tickets are £15 and available via Strictly By M Dancin' on Facebook or contact Paul on 07926241059.

Coffee Morning in Aid of Challenging MND will be held in The Den (Melmount Centre) on Saturday 24 October from 10.30am – 2.00pm. Every donation helps families living with Motor Neurone Disease. Everyone welcome.

Sion Mills Group of Alcohol Anonymous will hold a public information meeting on Wednesday 28 October at 8.30pm in Sion Mills Community Centre. Everyone welcome.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@ dlp@derrydiocese.org



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